crayonic Quick Start Guide

crayonic is an instrument that holds up to four one-shot sounds. Every note you play picks one of them at random, and each sound has its own pitch, filters, envelope, loop, arpeggiator and effects.

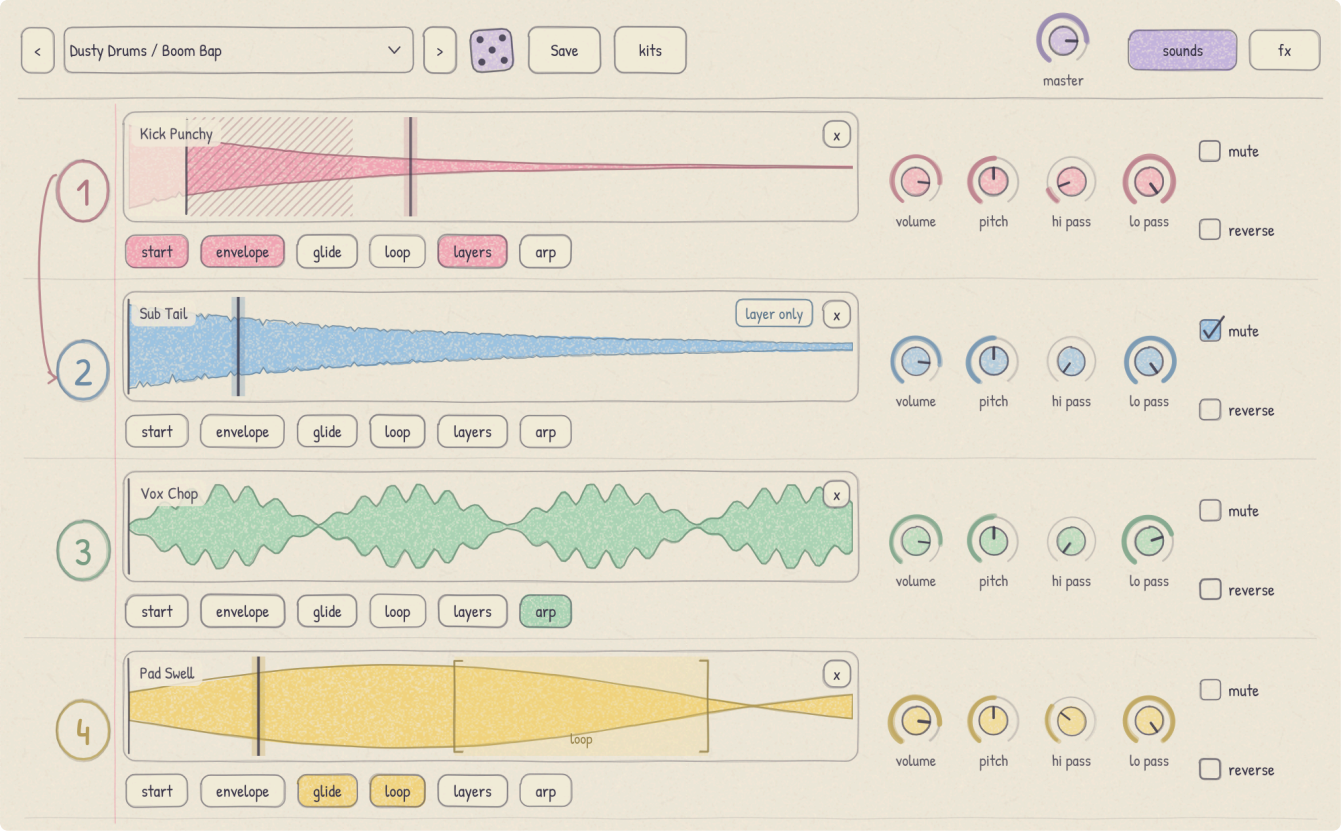
Getting started

Install it

- **Windows:** move the `.vst3` folder into `C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3`.
- **Mac:** open Terminal, type `bash ` (with a space), drag `install.command` into the window and press Enter. The READ ME FIRST file in the download explains why.

In FL Studio, open **Options → Manage plugins → Find installed plugins**. crayonic appears under **Generators**: add it to the Channel Rack and play it from the piano roll or a keyboard.

The main screen



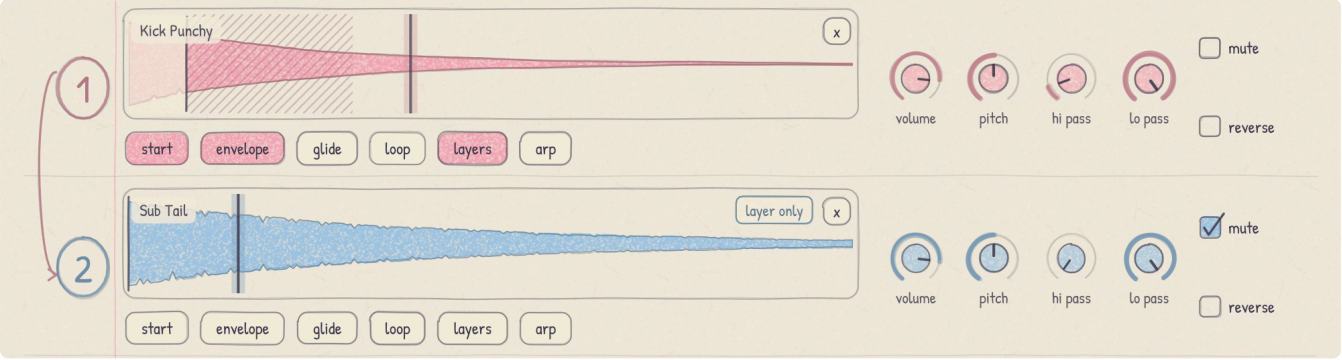
Area	What it does
Top left	Preset list, **<** and **>** arrows, the **dice** (random preset), **Save** and **kits**

Area	What it does
Top right	**master** volume, and the **sounds** / **fx** tabs
Each row (1–4)	One sound: its number, waveform, **volume**, **pitch**, **hi pass**, **lo pass**, **mute** and **reverse**
Buttons under a waveform	**start**, **envelope**, **glide**, **loop**, **layers**, **arp**: each opens a small note with more settings
Numbers and arrows on the left	Layer links between sounds (see Layers)

A button under a waveform is coloured in when that feature is in use, so you can see what each sound is doing without opening anything. Hover over most controls for a short tip.

Loading sounds

Drag an audio file (WAV, AIFF, FLAC, OGG) onto a waveform, from your file browser or FL's browser. You can also click an empty waveform to pick a file. Dropping several files at once fills that slot and the ones below it. The **x** in a waveform's corner removes its sound.



How notes pick a sound

Every note picks one loaded sound at random, and never the same sound twice in a row when there's a choice. The picked sound's number briefly gets a circle around it, and a moving line on its waveform shows what's playing.

C5 in FL (MIDI note 60) plays a sound at its original pitch; higher and lower notes transpose it.

Control	What it does
volume	The sound's level, in dB
pitch	Tunes the sound in semitones; it snaps to whole steps

Control	What it does
hi pass	Cuts the lows below the set frequency, for example to clean up rumble or thin out a sound. Fully left is off
lo pass	Cuts the highs above the set frequency, for example to darken a sound. Fully right is off
mute	Never picked on its own. It still plays as a layer if another sound links to it (see Layers)
reverse	Plays the sound backwards; the waveform flips to match

Using the knobs

Drag a knob's dial up or down to turn it. Every knob can be automated in FL.

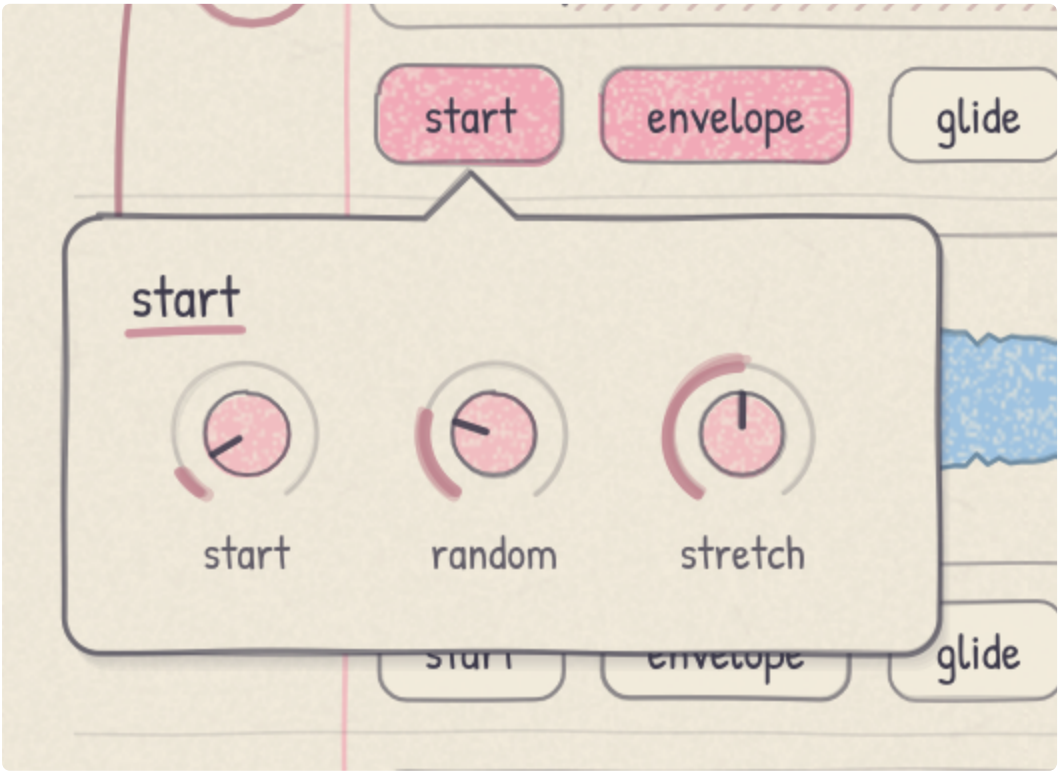
Action	Result
Hover or drag	The current value appears in a small bubble
Double-click	Resets the knob to its default
Right-click	Opens a box to type an exact value; press Enter to apply, Escape to cancel
Shift + drag (pitch knobs)	Moves freely instead of snapping to whole semitones
Drag the knob's **name** (or Alt/Option + drag)	Picks up a copy to drop on another sound (see Copying settings between sounds)



Typed values can include the unit (`7 st` , `-12` , `3.5` ; for the filters, `350` , `2k` or `off`). Anything out of range is clamped to the nearest allowed value.

Start, random start and stretch

Click **start** under a waveform to choose where the sound begins and how long it lasts.

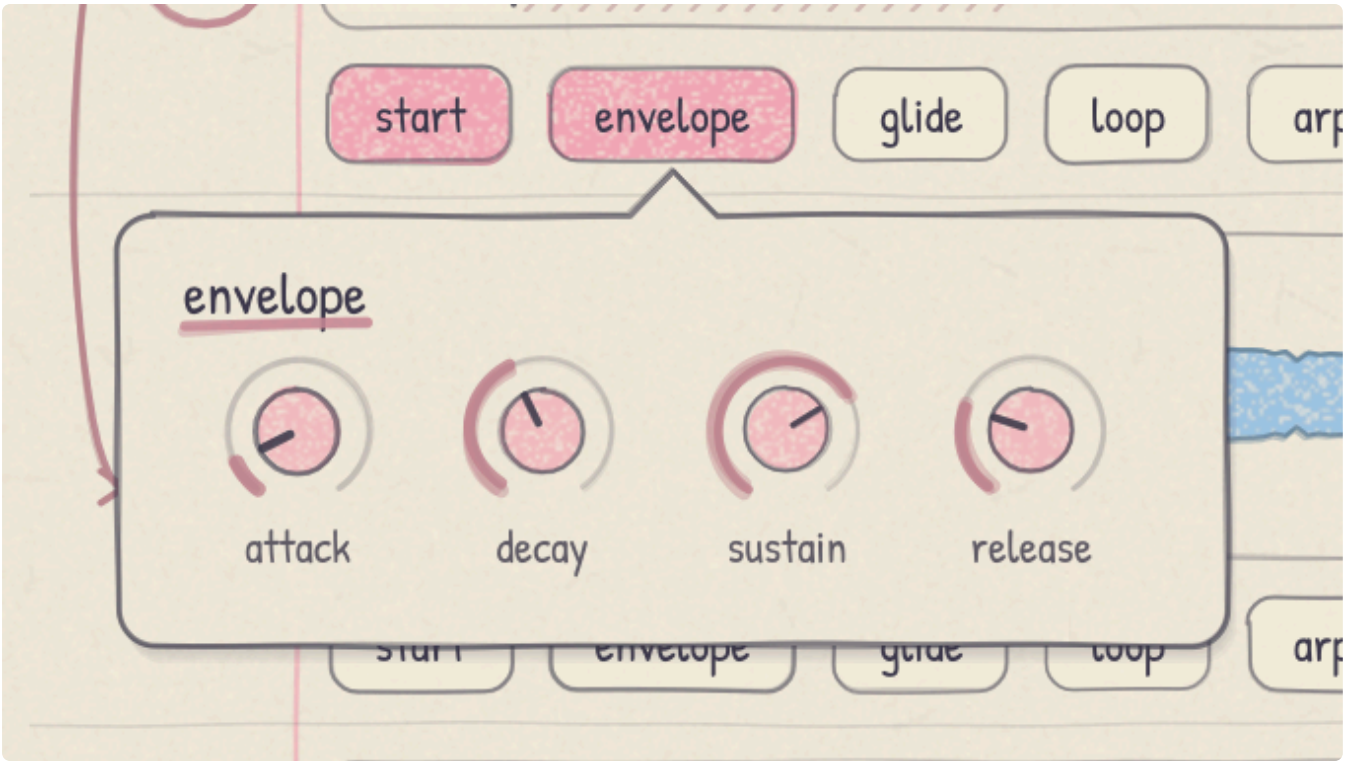


Knob	What it does
start	Skips the beginning of the sound. The skipped part is shown faded on the waveform
random	Each note starts at a random point between **start** and this far into the rest of the sound. The range shows as hatching
stretch	Makes the sound longer or shorter (25–400%) without changing its pitch. At 100% it's off, and higher notes play faster as on a classic sampler

With **stretch** away from 100%, every note lasts the same time whatever key you play, and pitch, glide and notes only change the pitch.

Envelope

Click **envelope** to shape how a sound fades in, holds and fades out. Each sound has its own envelope.



Knob	What it does
attack	Fade-in time at the start of a note
decay	Time to fall from full level to the sustain level
sustain	Level held while the key stays down
release	Fade-out time after you let go of the key

The defaults play the sound as it is while the key is held. Releasing a key starts the release, so short piano-roll notes can cut sounds off: lengthen the notes or raise **release** to hear more of the tail.

Glide and legato

Click **glide** to make a sound slide in pitch between notes. Both settings apply only to the sound they're turned on for.

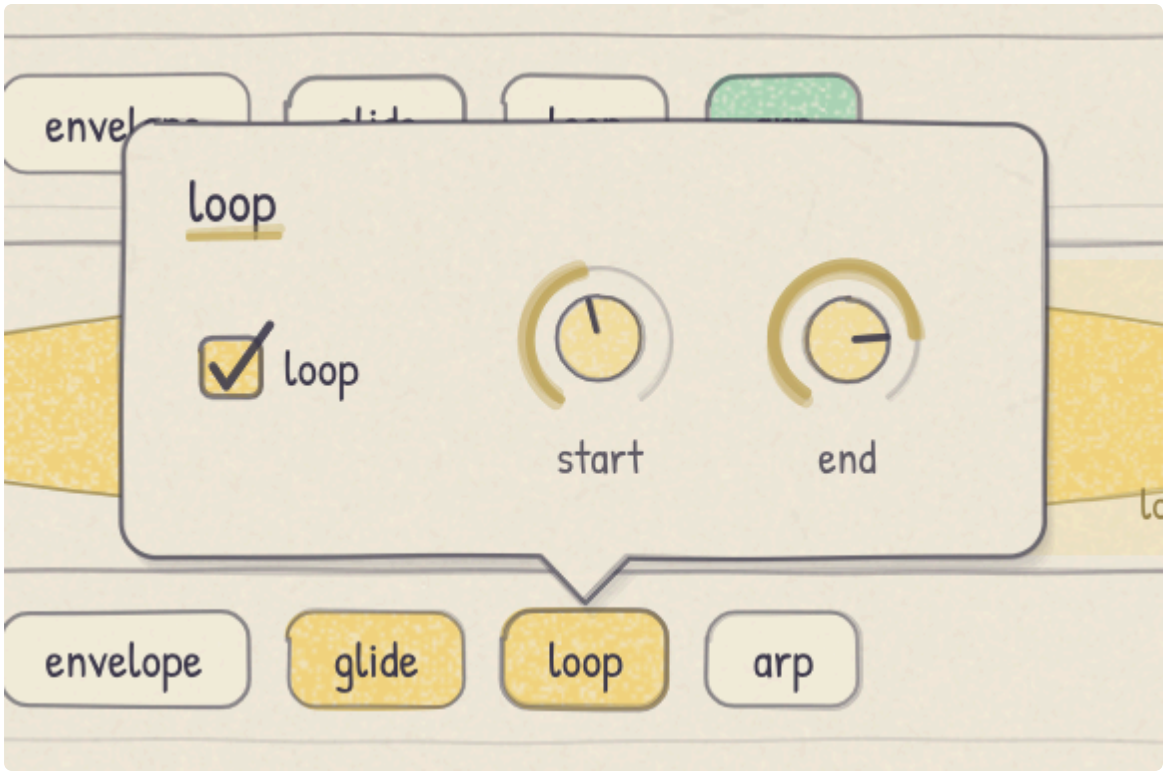


Setting	What it does
glide	The sound starts at the pitch of the previous note you played and slides to the new one
time	How long the slide takes
legato	While the key that started this sound is still held, a new key bends it to the new note instead of restarting it

Legato needs overlapping notes: in the piano roll, let each note run slightly past the start of the next. With **glide** also on, the bend slides; with glide off, it jumps. Other sounds are unaffected, and every key still picks a sound as usual.

Loop

Click **loop** to keep a sound going for as long as the key is held, like the loop in FL's own sampler.



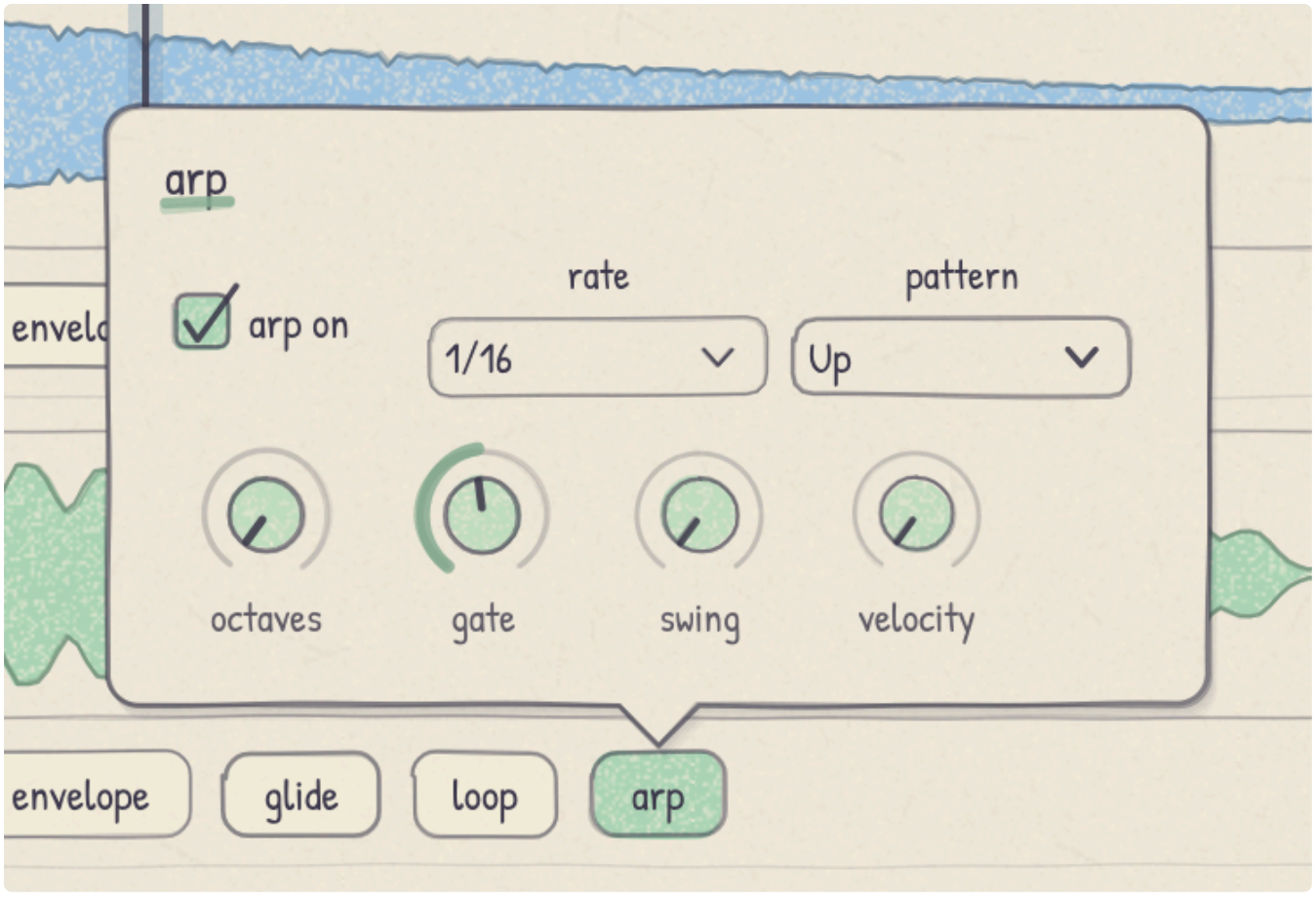
Setting	What it does
loop	Turns looping on for this sound
start	Where the loop begins
end	Where the loop ends

The sound plays normally from its start. When it reaches the loop **end**, it jumps back to the loop **start** and repeats until you release the key; then the envelope's release fades it out. The loop region shows on the waveform between two brackets, and the joins are crossfaded so they don't click.

With **random** start, a note that begins after the loop end plays to the end of the sound without looping.

Arpeggiator

Click **arp** and tick **arp on** to make a sound repeat in a rhythm while you hold a key. Each sound has its own arpeggiator, synced to FL's tempo.



Setting	What it does
rate	Step length: 1/4, 1/8, 1/8T, 1/16, 1/16T or 1/32
pattern	Note order: Up, Down, Up/Down, Random or As Played
octaves	Repeats the pattern 1 to 4 octaves up
gate	How long each step is held, as a percentage of the step
swing	Delays every second step for a shuffled feel
velocity	Fully left uses the velocity you played; otherwise every step uses this fixed velocity

The first step plays immediately and the arp stops when you release the key. Each step is a fresh hit, so random start, the envelope and glide apply to every step.

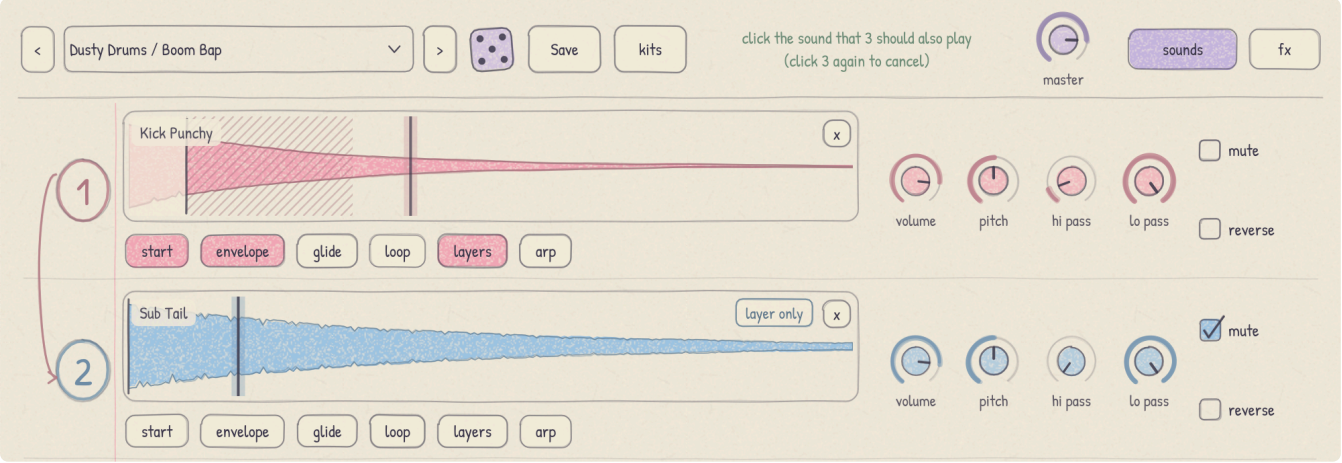
Layers

A layer link makes one sound always bring another along: whenever sound A is picked, the sounds it links to play with it.

To link two sounds

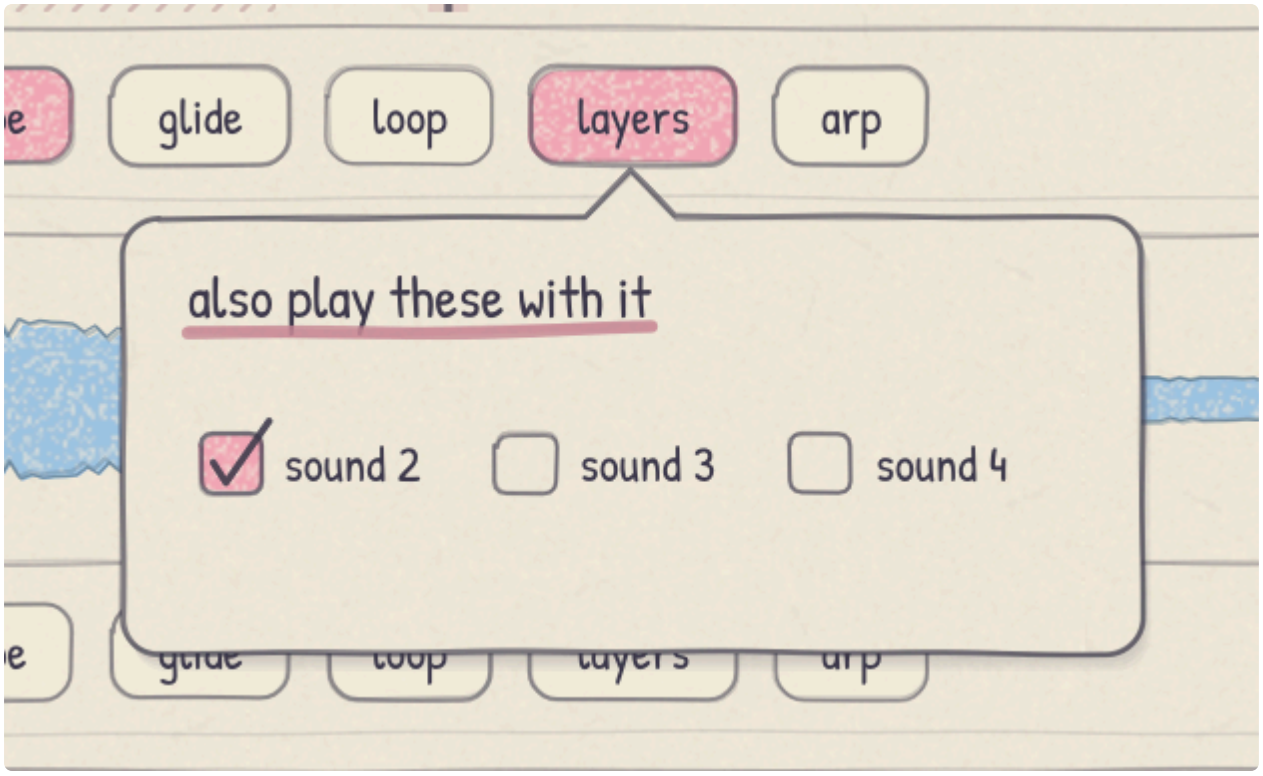
1. Click the number of the sound that should trigger the layer. Every number has a light pencil circle, and hovering over one shows a tip. The number gets circled firmly, and a hint appears at the top.
2. Click the number of the sound to add as its layer.

Click the same pair again to remove the link, or click the first number again to cancel.



Each link shows as an arrow in the left margin, from the trigger to its layer. The arrow lights up every time that layer plays, so you can see your links at work.

Or use the layers button. Click **layers** under a waveform and tick the sounds it should also play. It creates the same links as clicking numbers, and the button is coloured in when the sound has layers.



Rule	Example
Links work one way	With 1→2, picking 1 plays 1 and 2; picking 2 plays only 2
Link both ways to always pair them	With 1→2 and 2→1, they always play together
One sound can layer several	1→2 and 1→3 plays all three when 1 is picked
Links don't chain	With 1→2 and 2→3, picking 1 plays 1 and 2, not 3
A muted sound is "layer only"	Muted with a link pointing to it: never picked alone, but plays as a layer

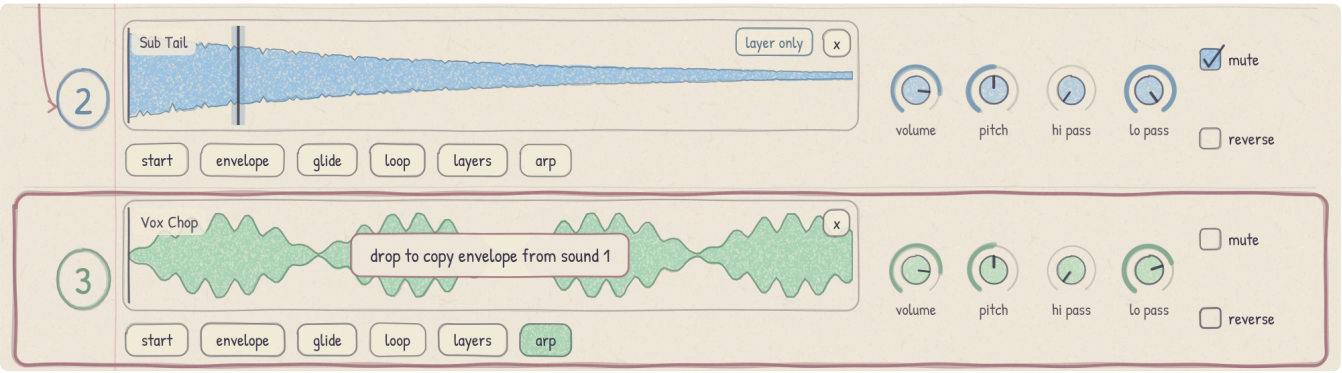
Layers follow their own settings: their own start, envelope, glide, legato, arp and effects. The waveform tags a muted sound **layer only** when something links to it, or **muted** (faded) when nothing does and it won't play.

Copying settings between sounds

Drag settings from one sound onto another to copy them.

Drag this	Onto	Copies
A knob's **name** ("attack", "hi pass"...), or Alt/Option + drag the knob	Another sound's row	That one setting

Drag this	Onto	Copies
A tab: **start**, **envelope**, **glide**, **loop**, **layers** or **arp**	Another sound's row	The whole group of settings
An effect card in the **fx** tab, by its background or **tweak**	Another sound's row in the fx tab	The whole effect



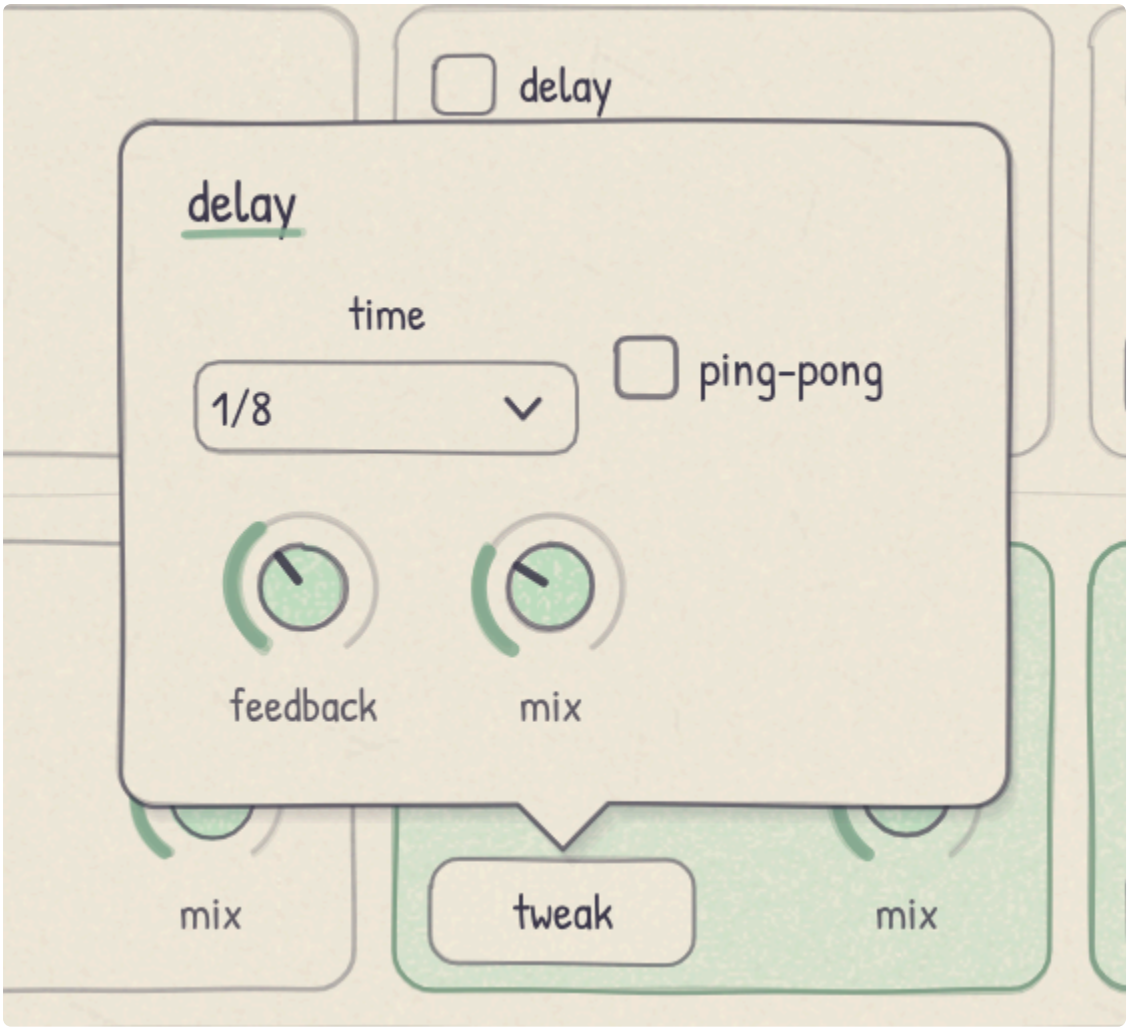
While you drag, a small tag shows what you picked up, and the sound under the mouse is outlined with a note saying what will be copied. Clicking a tab still opens it and dragging a dial still turns it. Sound files and the mute/reverse switches aren't copied.

Effects (the fx tab)

Click **fx** at the top right to give each sound its own effects. Effects on one sound never touch the others.



Each row is one sound, and its signal runs left to right through four effects. Tick an effect's box to turn it on; its card fills with colour. The **mix** knob sets how much of the effect you hear, and **tweak** opens the rest of its settings. You can adjust an effect while it's off and switch it on later.

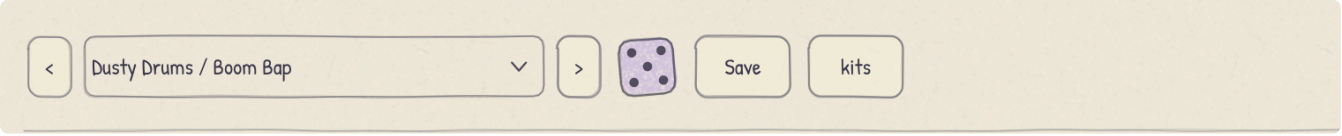


Effect	Settings
distortion	**type** (Soft, Hard, Fold, Crush), **drive**, **tone** (a low-pass filter on the distorted sound), **mix**
granular	Replays the sound as a cloud of tiny grains: **size**, **density** (grains per second), **spray** (how far back grains reach), **pitch**, **mix**
delay	**time** (synced to tempo, 1/16 to 1/2), **feedback**, **ping-pong** (echoes bounce left and right), **mix**
reverb	**size**, **damping**, **width**, **mix**

Delay and reverb tails keep ringing after a note ends. To copy an effect to another sound, drag its card onto that sound's row.

Presets

A preset saves everything on both tabs: all four sounds, every knob and switch, the layer links and the effects.



Control	What it does
Save	Saves the current setup as a preset, in the folder or kit you're working in
Preset list	Loads a preset; kits appear as submenus. Also has **Init** (reset everything) and **Open preset file...**
< and **>**	Step through all your presets, kits included
dice	Loads a random preset from your whole library
kits	Create, export and import kits, and choose where presets are kept

Kits

A kit is a folder of presets that can be shared together with every sound they use.

In the kits menu	What it does
Create kit...	Makes a new, empty kit. Save presets into it
Export kit	Packs a kit's presets and all their sounds into one zip, ready to send
Import kit...	Adds a kit someone sent you: pick the zip, and it appears in your preset list
Show presets folder	Opens the presets folder in Explorer or Finder
Change presets folder...	Keeps presets anywhere, even on another drive. The choice is remembered

Presets live in `Documents/crayonic/Presets` unless you choose another folder. FL projects also remember which preset was loaded. If a preset's sound can't be found, that slot loads empty and everything else still loads.